

Attachment 9

Description of Participant Recruitment

To Renounce Liberty? A Public-Goods Experiment on (Un)Democratic Reversal

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Population and selection

The target sample is approximately 400 adults recruited through the University of Turku PCRC Decision Laboratory participant pool for sessions planned between 1 and 31 October 2026. Eligibility is limited to people aged 18 or older who can understand the study language (Finnish) and attend the full session, which lasts approximately 60 minutes. No political opinion, prior game experience, academic field, or expected choice is used as a selection criterion.

PCRC will distribute the approved neutral advertisement through its usual participant-pool and scheduling channels. Interested individuals register voluntarily for available sessions. Recruitment will seek complete multiples of ten because the task uses fixed ten-person matching pools. When operationally necessary, the laboratory may invite standby participants; they may enter only before the first paid round. Duplicate participation will be prevented through normal laboratory scheduling records.

Recruitment and scheduling information is administered separately from experimental responses. PCRC retains the identifying information needed for attendance and payment and gives researchers only coded experimental data. Its temporary identity-to-code link is deleted when payment is complete. No teacher, employer, or direct supervisor will recruit subordinates, and participation or refusal will not affect studies, employment, grades, services, or future eligibility for unrelated research.

Information and consent procedure

The invitation gives the study location, duration, broad topic, eligibility, and expected payment without disclosing directional hypotheses. Before any paid task, participants receive the participant information sheet and privacy notice and may ask the researcher or laboratory manager questions.

The oTree interface then presents the informed-consent text. Participants must affirm that they are at least 18, have read the study information, understand that participation is voluntary, and agree to participate. A person who does not consent will not enter the interactive task; the laboratory manager will handle the session composition before paid play begins.

Participants may stop later without giving a reason. Because the task is synchronized, they are asked to notify the laboratory manager, who will manage the interruption without allowing another person to inherit their decisions. The fixed participation payment and any performance earnings will be handled under the approved laboratory payment procedure. Data already collected are processed as stated in the privacy notice.

Compensation and follow-up

Participants receive EUR 10 plus a points-based performance bonus of up to EUR 5, determined by one randomly selected round from each block. The maximum total payment is EUR 15. Payment administration and any legally required reporting information remain separate from research responses. PCRC deletes the identity-to-code link after payment; researchers cannot subsequently use the coded dataset to identify a participant. No additional contact is planned after payment.